universität wien

Department of Government

QUESTIONNAIRE FOR CANDIDATES IN THE 2008 AUSTRIAN ELECTIONS

This questionnaire is part of an international and comparative research project on campaigning, based on a co-operation of the University of Vienna, the Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES) and more than 20 other universities in Europe, America and Asia. It was first conducted in Austria in the context of the 2006 national election (see enclosed brochure).

The questionnaire can be completed quickly and easily by ticking a box or providing a short written answer. It should take you about 30 minutes to answer all the questions. We would very much appreciate if you could spend this short amount of your valuable time to contribute to our research.

Please provide those answers that best reflect your own views or situation. If you do not approve of one of our questions and/or would rather not provide an answer, please turn to the next question.

All your answers and statements will be treated as confidential. The data will only be used for scientific research and analysis. All answers will only be used and published in such a way that a corresponding individual can no longer be identified (this is also illustrated in the enclosed brochure). If you have any further questions, feel free to contact me by e-mail or telephone.

I would like to thank you for your contribution to our research!

If you are interested in any of the results, please see page 18.

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Once you have completed this questionnaire, please send it back to us in the enclosed envelope. You do not need to pay any postage or to stamp it.

A: Political Background and Activities

A1. For which party did you run in this election?

SPÖ	ÖVP	GRÜNE	FPÖ	BZÖ
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

FRITZ	DC	KPÖ	LIF	RETTÖ	LINKE	STARK	TRP	KHK
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

A2. What is your party (membership)?

SPÖ	ÖVP	GRÜNE	FPÖ	BZÖ	NONE	OTHER*
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

FRITZ	DC	KPÖ	LIF	RETTÖ	LINKE	STARK	TRP	KHK
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

*** If other: please specify:** _____

A3. In which year did you join this party? ☐☐☐☐

A4. Have you ever been a member of another party? If yes, of which party or parties?

no	yes	if yes, please specify: party	from …	until …
☐	☐		(not in CCS)	(not in CCS)
			(not in CCS)	(not in CCS)

A5. How important were the following reasons for your personal decision to become involved in your party?

(Tick one box in each row!)	very important	fairly important	not very important	not at all important
a. The party represented my own values and political opinions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. Family members have been involved in the party.	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. My friends have been involved in the party.	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. The party offered me a chance to take on political responsibilities.	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. I wanted to meet interesting people.	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. Party membership was helpful for my career.	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. I became involved via my activities in a union, club or association.	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. I was invited by the party.	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. I wanted to support a real political alternative to the other parties.	☐	☐	☐	☐

A6. How important where the following reasons for your personal decision to run for your party in this election?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**very important**	**fairly important**	**not very important**	**not at all important**
a. To win a mandate.	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. To take a step forward in my political career.	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. To show loyalty with my party.	☐	☐	☐	☐

A7. Before becoming a candidate for the Nationalrat, were you ever employed in a State or Federal MPs or minister"s office?

no	**yes**	**If yes: for how many years?**
☐	☐	_____ **years**

A8. Have you ever worked as a paid employee for this party?

no	**yes**	**If yes: for how many years?**
☐	☐	_____ **years**

A9. Are you a member of any of the organisations or associations listed below? How often did you meet during the past 12 months?

	How often met during past 12 months?					**Member?**	
	never	**once or twice**	**every 3 months**	**once a month**	**once a week**	**yes**	**no**
a. labour union	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. Workers" and Employees association	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. Chamber of Agriculture	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Austrian Federal Economic Chamber	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. other chamber (or association)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. Federation of Austrian Industries	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. social organisation (e.g. scouts, homeless support)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. interest group	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. citizen action group	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
j. sports club (e.g. football, tennis)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
k. cultural organisation (e.g. history, arts)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
l. religious organisation (e.g. city mission, presbytery)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
m. hobbies group (e.g. chess, choir)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

A10. Please indicate how many years you have held a ...
(Please print "0" for never.)

a. local party office	_____	years
b. regional party office	_____	years
c. national party office	_____	years

A11. And how many years have you been a ...
(Please print "0" for never.)

a. Mayor	_____	years
b. member of a regional government	_____	years
c. member of the national government	_____	years
d. member of a local assembly	_____	years
e. member of a regional assembly	_____	years
f. member of the national parliament	_____	years
g. member of the European Parliament	_____	years

A12. Prior to the election campaign, about how much time do you usually devote to party activities in an average month?

none	**up to 10 hours**	**more than 10 hours**	**more than 20 hours**	**more than 40 hours**
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

B: Campaigning

B1. About how much time did you devote to campaigning per week during the last month before the election?

_____ hours **per week**

B2. During this final month of the campaign, how many hours per week did you **personally** spend on the following campaign activities?

a. door-knocking, canvassing	_____	hours per week
b. calling up voters on the phone	_____	hours per week
c. direct mailing	_____	hours per week
d. debating with competing candidates in public	_____	hours per week
e. providing information and communicating via the internet	_____	hours per week
f. meeting local party members	_____	hours per week
g. meeting regional party officials or other candidates	_____	hours per week
h. meeting national party officials	_____	hours per week
i. visiting national events in business, sports and culture	_____	hours per week
j. visiting local events in business, sports and culture	_____	hours per week
k. appointments with companies in constituency	_____	hours per week
l. appointments with associations and clubs in constituency	_____	hours per week
m. appointments with NGOs in constituency	_____	hours per week
n. appointments with citizen action groups in constituency	_____	hours per week
o. organising and joining large rallies in the constituency	_____	hours per week
p. local and regional newspaper interviews	_____	hours per week
q. national newspaper interviews	_____	hours per week
r. local and regional radio and TV interviews	_____	hours per week
s. national radio and TV interviews	_____	hours per week
t. other campaign activities	_____	hours per week

B3. Not considering your party's website, did you as a candidate make use of the internet to reach voters?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**no**	**yes**
a. I had an own webpage which was largely designed and maintained by the party.	☐	☐
b. I had an own webpage which was largely designed and maintained by my local campaign.	☐	☐
c. I used EMAIL LISTS to distribute information and organise activities.	☐	☐
d. I offered a personal campaign video on the web.	☐	☐
e. I conducted a number of online chats with voters.	☐	☐
f. I advertised my webpage and/or email address in my campaign leaflets.	☐	☐
g. I used a blog during my campaign.	☐	☐

B4. Now thinking about the overall campaign, did you use any of the following means? If yes, how important were they?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**no**	**yes**	**very important**	**fairly important**	**not very important**	**not at all important**
a. door-knocking, canvassing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. own campaign events / rally	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. personal campaign posters	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. personal ads in the local press	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. office hours	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. social gatherings	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. personal flyers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. personal spots in radio, TV, and movie houses	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. personal website	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

B5. Independently from your party, did your personal campaign produce any of the above campaign means?

no	**yes**	**If yes: which ones?**
☐	☐	

B6. Did you raise any issues during your campaign that were specific to your constituency and that were not raised by the national or regional party?

no	**yes**	**If yes, what were the most important ones?**
☐	☐	

B7. What was the primary aim of your campaign? Where would you place yourself on a scale from 1 to 11, where 1 means "to attract as much attention as possible for me as a candidate" and 11 means "to attract as much as possible attention for my party"? *(Tick just one box.)*

attract as much attention as possible for me										**attract as much attention as possible for my party**
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)

B8. How strongly did you emphasise each of the following in your campaign?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**not at all**	**not much**	**much**	**very much**
a. Taking care of the economic well-being of the constituency.	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. Advocating the policy demands of the voters in the constituency.	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. Openness to the voters in the constituency and communicating with them extensively.	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Promoting local customs and traditions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. My own political experience.	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. My party's manifesto.	☐	☐	☐	☐

B9. How long before the election …

(Tick one box in each row!)	**more than two months**	**more than one month**	**one or less than one month**
a. … have you been nominated by your party?	☐	☐	☐
b. … did you begin organising your campaign?	☐	☐	☐
c. …did you start campaigning full-time?	☐	☐	☐

B10. Was your recent nomination as a candidate contested?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**not at all**	**not much**	**much**	**very much**	**no candidacy**
a. for federal list	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. for Land list	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. for electoral district	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

B11. Did you have your own personal campaign team? If yes, how large was it?

no	**yes**
☐	☐

Number of people: _____

B12. Did you have your own personal campaign funds? If yes: Thinking about your campaign budget, what would be your best estimate (including party funds, donations, and private funds)?

no	**yes**
☐	☐

Campaign fundes (estimate): _____ **€**

B13. What portion of that sum came from the party, from donations, and from your own private funds?

a. party funds	approx.	_____	percent
b. donations	approx.	_____	percent
c. private funds	approx.	_____	percent

B14. How intensively did you coordinate your campaign with …

(Tick one box in each row!)	**not at all**	**not much**	**much**	**very much**
a. your national party organization?	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. your regional party organization?	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. the party organization in your district?	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. your local party organization?	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. other organizations within your party?	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. other candidates of your party?	☐	☐	☐	☐

B15. Did members of the central party leadership visit your constituency during the campaign?

no	**yes, once**	**yes, more than once**
☐	☐	☐

B16. What was the aim of your personal campaign?

to win as many preferential votes as possible for myself	**to win as many preferential votes as possible for another candidate**	**to win as many party votes as possible**	**to win as many party as well as preferential votes as possible**
☐	☐	☐	☐

B17. In the beginning of the campaign, how did you evaluate your chances to win the mandate?

I thought I could not win	**I thought I could hardly win**	**I thought it was an open race**	**I though I could hardly lose**	**I thought I could not lose**
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

B18. Did you try to get any sort of media attention?

no	**yes**
☐	☐

If yes, how hard was that attempt?

very easy	**fairly easy**	**fairly hard**	**very hard**
☐	☐	☐	☐

B19. Thinking about your personal campaign efforts: What would you estimate as the proportion of party votes in your electoral district that resulted from your own personal dedication and work during the campaign?

_____ proportion of party votes (**in percent**)

B20. How important are the following candidate's attributes for their personal success in a campaign?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**very important**						**not at all important**
a. competence	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. character	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. leadership	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. charisma	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. openness to the voters	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. experience	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)

B21. How much did the following factors contribute to the election result of your party?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**very much**						**nothing at all**
a. issue positions of the party	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. top candidate of the party	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. other candidates of the party	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. dedication and work of party and officials and party members	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. the party's ability and competence to govern	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. the snap elections	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. campaign strategies of the party	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. level of media coverage about the party	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. the positions of some print media during the campaign	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
j. the global banking and financial crisis	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
k. the legislative enactments in the last pre-electoral meeting of parliament	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
l. expectations about the election results	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
m. statements of my party concerning potential coalitions	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
n. statements of other parties concerning potential coalitions	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
o. voters" coalition considerations	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
p. electoral law	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)

C: Issues and Policies

C1. In your opinion, what are the three most important political problems facing Austria today? *(Please write in.)*

	Today	During the election campaign
a. The most important problem is:	_____	(not in CCS)
b. The second most important is:	_____	(not in CCS)
c. The third most important is:	_____	(not in CCS)

C2. How interested were the voters in the following policies and topics during the campaign?

(Tick one box in each row!)	very much	much	not much	not at all
a. economic policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. taxes	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. social policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. EU, European policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. immigration	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. civil and social rights	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. justice	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. law enforcement	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. foreign policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
j. national defence	☐	☐	☐	☐
k. neutrality (of Austria)	☐	☐	☐	☐
l. education	☐	☐	☐	☐
m. environmental policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
n. energy policy	☐	☐	☐	☐
o. infrastructure	☐	☐	☐	☐
p. affairs and scandals	☐	☐	☐	☐
q. coalition formation	☐	☐	☐	☐

C3. Irrespectively of the currently planned tax reform, what is your opinion about an appropriate top income tax rate?

_____ top income tax rate (**in percent**) *(currently 50 percent)* for: _____ annual income (**€**) *(currently € 51.001)*

C4. Thinking about the currently planned tax reform: Which income groups should most profit from this reform?

annual income (total)

up to € 10.000	€ 10.001 to € 20.000	€ 20.001 to € 25.000	€ 25.001 to € 30.000	€ 30.001 to € 40.000	€ 40.001 to € 50.000	€ 50.001 and higher
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

C5. People hold different views on political issues. What do you think of the following?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**strongly agree**	**agree**	**neither**	**disagree**	**strongly disagree**
a. Immigrants should be required to adapt to the customs of Austria.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. The state should not hold ownership of business companies.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. Any market economy can only work with strong regulation by the state.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Stronger measures should be taken to protect the environment.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. Same-sex marriages should be prohibited by law.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. Women should be given preferential treatment when applying for jobs and promotions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. People who break the law should be given stiffer sentences.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
h. Our democracy needs serious reform.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
i. Immigrants are good for Austria's economy.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
j. The rights and freedoms of individual citizens should be protected under all circumstances.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
k. Globalisation should be promoted.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
l. Providing a stable network of social security should be the prime goal of government.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
m. Fighting unemployment is more important than containing inflation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
n. Income and wealth should be redistributed towards ordinary people.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
o. Women should be free to decide on matters of abortion.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
p. Torturing a prisoner is never justified, even if it might prevent a terrorist attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
q. Austria should provide military assistance to "the war on terror".	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

C6. In politics, people sometimes talk about the „left" and the „right". Where would you place your own views on a scale from 1 to 11, where 1 means the most left and 11 means the most right? *(Tick just one box.)*

left										**right**
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)

C7. Using the same scale, where would you place Austria's parties?
(Tick one box in each row!) (In CCS: Own party only!)

	left										**right**
SPÖ	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ÖVP	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
GRÜNE	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
FPÖ	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
BZÖ	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
FRITZ	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
DC	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
KPÖ	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LIF	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
RETTÖ	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)

C8. Generally speaking, do you think that Austria's membership of the European Union is a good thing, a bad thing, or neither good nor bad? *(Tick one box only.)*

a good thing	**a bad thing**	**neither good nor bad**
☐	☐	☐

C9. In your opinion, should Austria remain a member of the European Union or should it withdraw from the EU?

remain a member	**withdraw from the EU**	**withdraw under certain circumstances**
☐	☐	☐

C10. Some say European unification should be pushed further. Others say it already has gone too far. What is your opinion? *(Tick one box only.)*

has already gone too far										**should be pushed further**
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)

C11. All in all, are you very satisfied, fairly satisfied, not very satisfied or not at all satisfied with the way democracy works in the European Union?

very satisfied	**fairly satisfied**	**not very satisfied**	**not at all satisfied**
☐	☐	☐	☐

C12. How should changes and revisions of EU treaties be ratified? What is your opinion about substantial changes and revisions of EU treaties, changes and revisions important from an Austrian perspective, and any changes?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**act of the national parliament (qualified majority)**	**act of the national parliament + national referendum**	**act of the national parliament + EU-wide referendum**
a. substantial chances and revisions of EU treaties	☐	☐	☐
b. changes and revisions of EU treaties important from an Austrian perspective	☐	☐	☐
c. any changes and revisions of EU treaties	☐	☐	☐

C13. Should the EU be enlarged to include more countries?

yes, definitely	**yes, probably**	**undecided**	**no, probably not**	**no, definitely not**
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If yes (definitely and probably): Which further countries should be admitted?

_____

_____

D: Democracy and Representation

D1. On the whole are you very satisfied, fairly satisfied, not very satisfied or not at all satisfied with the way democracy works in Austria?

very satisfied	**fairly satisfied**	**not very satisfied**	**not at all satisfied**
☐	☐	☐	☐

D2. What do you generally think about the formation of a government without a parliamentary majority, i.e. a minority government?

The government needs a majority of seats in parliament	**A majority of seats in parliament is not that important**
☐	☐

D3. Thinking about the performance of the national government: Generally speaking, did they do a good job or a bad job in the last legislative term?

did a very good job	**did a fairly good job**	**did a fairly bad job**	**did a very bad job**
☐	☐	☐	☐

D4. There are different opinions about whom an elected member of parliament should primarily represent. What is your opinion?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**very important**						**not important**
a. Own voters in the constituency.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. All citizens in the constituency.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. The party electorate at large.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Their party.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. Members of a social group.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. The Austrian citizenry.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)

D5. What should an elected MP accomplish in his/her electoral district? Please rank the following goals from the most important (1) to the least important (5).

a. Providing services and help to people of the constituency coping with individual problems.	_____
b. Advocating the policy demands of the voters in the constituency.	_____
c. Taking care of the economic well-being of the constituency.	_____
d. Openness to the voters in the constituency and communicating with them extensively.	_____
e. Promoting local customs and traditions.	_____

D6. Thinking about how elections in Austria work in practice, how well do you think they ensure that the views of MPs accurately reflect the views of voters?

very well	**fairly well**	**not very well**	**not well at all**
☐	☐	☐	☐

D7. How should a Member of Parliament vote in parliament?

(Tick one box in each row!)

a. If the voters in his/her constituency have one opinion and his/her party takes a different position?	☐	MP should vote according to his/her party's opinion	☐	MP should vote according to his/her voters opinion
b. If his/her own opinion on an issue does not correspond with the opinion of the voters in his/her constituency?	☐	MP should vote according to his/her own opinion	☐	MP should vote according to the opinion of the voters in his/her constituency
c. If his/her own opinion on an issue does not correspond with his/her party's opinion?	☐	MP should vote according to his/her own opinion	☐	MP should vote according to his/her party's opinion

D8. Do you agree or disagree with the following statements on the work of parliament in the last legislative period?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**strongly agree**	**agree**	**neither**	**disagree**	**strongly disagree**
a. Decisions on the EU level have been deliberated sufficiently in the Nationalrat (national parliament).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. The government was ready to compromise with the opposition in legislative decision-making.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. The opposition made constructive contributions towards legislation.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Parliamentary control of the government was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. The most important problems in Austria and their potential solutions have been well covered and communicated in the parliamentary debates.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

D9. Recently, demands have been issued for electoral reform in Austria. In your opinion, what is the most important function of an electoral system?

To adequately represent the opinions and preferences of voters in parliament.	**To allow the formation the formation of a stable majority government without delay.**
☐	☐

D10. Should the electoral law be reformed substantially, reformed to some extent, or should it remain unchanged?

electoral law should be reformed substantially	**electoral law should be reformed to some extent**	**electoral law should remain unchanged**
☐	☐	☐

D11. If you support a reform of the electoral law in Austria, what changes or innovations would you favour?
(Please make notes!)

D12. Do you agree or disagree with the following statements on direct democracy in Austria?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**strongly agree**	**agree**	**neither**	**disagree**	**strongly disagree**
a. Referendums enable citizens to get politicians attention.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. Referendums are poorly thought out and make bad law.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. Referendums should be used more often for making important decisions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Parliament, not voters, should make final decisions on law and policy.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. Referendums help to stimulate political interest.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. A certain number of citizens should be able to initiate a referendum.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

D13. Do you agree or disagree with the following statements on democracy in Austria?

(Tick one box in each row!)	**strongly agree**	**agree**	**neither**	**disagree**	**strongly disagree**
a. Citizens have ample opportunity to participate in political decisions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. Our democracy is about to lose the trust of the citizens.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. The legislation reflects the interests of the majority of the population.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Political parties are the essential link between citizens and the state.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. Special interests have too much influence on law making.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
f. Too many legislative acts in the Austrian parliament require a qualified majority (2/3 of votes).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
g. Austria"s membership in the European Union leaves too little leeway for national government and parliament.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

E: You and Your Background

E1. Are you …

male ☐ **female** ☐

E2. Year of birth

1	9		

E3. Country of birth

in Austria ☐

abroad ☐ **If abroad, please specify:** _____

E4. If born abroad:
When did you first come to Austria?

E5. If born abroad:
When did you become a citizen?

E6. What is your level of education?
(Tick one box only!)

Primary school completed	Secondary school (incomplete)	Secondary school (complete)	University (incomplete)	University (complete)	Other degree or level of education
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

E7. Irrespective of whether or not you are a Member of Parliament, what is your employment status? Are you …

	full time	part time
a. self-employed (freelancer)	☐	☐
b. self-employed	☐	☐
c. employee (white-colour worker)	☐	☐
d. civil servant, public official	☐	☐
e. blue-colour worker (manual worker)	☐	☐
f. farmer	☐	☐
g. retired	☐	☐
h. housewife, responsible for home duties	☐	☐
i. student, in school, vocational training	☐	☐
j. unemployed	☐	
k. others not in the labour force	☐	

E8. What is your religion?

roman catholic	protestant	other christian	muslim	jewish	hinduism	other religions	none
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)

E9. About how often do you attend religious services these days? *(Tick one box only!)*

at least once a week	at least once a month	at least once a year	less often or never
☐	☐	☐	☐

E10. What is your current marital status? *(Tick one box only!)*

married	divorced	widowed	living in cohabitation	single
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

E11. We have one last question for you: can you please, very briefly, indicate what "left" and "right" means in politics to you nowadays?

„Left" means:

_____

_____

_____

„Right" means:

_____

_____

_____

This is the end of the questionnaire .

Thank you again for your co-operation!

If you would like to obtain a summary of the results of this survey, please provide an e-mail address below. You can also submit your e-mail address electronically or by mail. Due to financial limitations we are only able to provide the summary by electronic means.

e-mail: _____

If you would like to provide any additional statements, please use this page.